

ANUJA HARSHA NIMMAGADDA

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STAFF PRODUCT DESIGNER | PRODUCT STRATEGIST

SUMMARY

Strategic design leader, high-agency Product Owner, and de facto organizational unblocker with 13+ years of experience transforming highly ambiguous technical constraints into intuitive enterprise software. I operate as a force multiplier between engineering, product management, and design, specializing in zero-to-one product execution, complex legacy modernization, and the data workflow problems most designers avoid.

Leveraging a zero-ego builder mentality and advanced AI-agent prompting, I act as an empathy bridge to engineering—decoding backend constraints to write functional specs, eliminate structural friction, and ship runtime-feasible, production-ready UI.

TECHNICAL AND DESIGN SKILLS

- Product Strategy:** Systems Architecture, Zero-to-One Product Execution, Extreme Ambiguity Resolution, Legacy System Modernization, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Business Intelligence (BI) / Data Analytics.
- Domain Expertise:** B2B Enterprise SaaS, Machine Learning/Artificial Intelligence Infrastructure, Data Analytics Pipelines, Cybersecurity UX, Fintech Compliance.
- AI-Native Prototyping:** Agentic AI Workflows (Cursor, Claude Code, Google Antigravity), Rapid Prototyping, Context-Aware Prompting, Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Product DesignerAugust 2022 - November 2025

Cloud Software Group (ibi WebFOCUS)

Commanded the cross-organizational product vision for WebFOCUS, a mission-critical data platform within a \$175M P&L enterprise business unit. By architecting a consolidated analytics platform and driving deep product modernizations, I directly enabled enterprise deal expansion—boosting competitive win rates and cross-sell opportunities across Fortune 500 accounts.

- High-Stakes Legacy Modernization:** Led the execution of a 2025 Dresner Award-winning modernization for an undocumented, 50-year-old scheduling engine. Re-architected workflows processing 20M+ weekly jobs, effectively modernizing 50% of the complex B2B platform.
- Systems Architecture & Cultural Transformation:** Acted as the absolute connective tissue across 3 global time zones, dedicating significant bandwidth to aligning 4 PMs, a 30+ person engineering org, and distributed QA. Successfully transitioned engineering's perception of UX from "decoration" to a core strategic pillar, establishing deep trust with veteran engineers to secure buy-in for a cloud-native overhaul.
- Enterprise AI & ML Strategy:** Architected the unified B2B Data Science and Machine Learning Hub (IQ Plugin), bringing order to system fragmentation by consolidating three isolated workflows (NLQ, Insights, ML) into a single unified entry point.

- **Technical Feasibility & Engineering Velocity:** Partnered directly with veteran Principal Data Scientists to conduct rigorous technical discovery on predictive models. Translated complex backend logic into crystal-clear functional specs and UI workflows, achieving 100% SME discoverability and driving a 25% increase in Natural Language Query adoption.

Fractional Product Design Leader | Principal Consultant

April 2017 - July 2022

- **Zero-to-One Product Architecture:** Retained by executive teams as a fractional design leader to direct end-to-end product architecture for early-stage B2B and SaaS startups (OneView, Kedazzle). Successfully navigated absolute ambiguity to establish scalable design-to-engineering workflows from the ground up.
- **Systemic Friction Resolution:** Acted as a specialized consultant to resolve broken development pipelines. Translated complex business requirements into high-fidelity specifications and production-ready CSS, permanently reducing engineering handover cycles from three rounds of friction down to one.
- **Rapid Domain Acquisition & Client Partnership:** Parachuted into highly complex, specialized client environments to deliver immediate organizational ROI. Acted as the strategic client liaison to untangle ambiguous demands, successfully architecting everything from a Fintech Exception Management dashboard to cross-platform IoT cybersecurity controls.

Enterprise Product Designer

November 2016 - March 2017

f1Studioz

- **Accelerated Complex Onboarding:** Parachuted into complex, in-flight enterprise projects to architect data-heavy B2B dashboards and functional workflows under aggressive, client-driven timelines.
- **Multi-Platform Systems Design:** Led the end-to-end architectural redesign of a multi-platform enterprise facility management system (Web, Mobile, Tablet), establishing scalable patterns for seamless cross-device synchronization.
- **Client-Facing Leadership:** Acted as the primary strategic liaison between enterprise clients, product managers, and engineering teams. Translated highly ambiguous client demands into strict functional requirements to protect engineering scopes and ensure rapid delivery.

Founding Product Designer

August 2012 - November 2016

9P Studioz

- **Foundational Design Leadership:** Operated as the solo founding designer for a high-velocity tech incubator, managing end-to-end UX architecture and startup demands across multiple concurrent ventures.
- **High-Velocity Execution (Time-to-Value):** Directed the design-to-engineering pipeline to successfully ship 35+ digital products across iOS and Android. Forged the early operational muscle to balance rapid agile execution with the rigorous technical demands of scaling platforms.
- **Product Strategy & Growth:** Designed retention-loop mechanics and iterated on session analytics to achieve high-impact launches, collaborating directly with engineering leaders under strict startup constraints.

BUILD LAB — AI-NATIVE PRODUCTS I DESIGNED & SHIPPED

Self-initiated AI-native products I designed, built, and shipped end-to-end — using agentic AI (Claude Code, Cursor) as a force multiplier to take ideas from concept to live, production software. Technical empathy in practice: I don't hand designs off, I ship them runtime-ready.

- **This Portfolio (live):** The site you're reading — a fully custom Next.js / React / Three.js experience, architected and AI-orchestrated across 5 iterations with 6 specialized agents.
- **Sous — AI cooking companion (2026):** Voice-first native iOS app (Expo / React Native) with a Claude reasoning brain and a live voice mode; preparing for App Store launch.
- **Pathwise — AI career & education navigator (2026, live):** A decision engine that projects education ROI and career paths from real, cited data. Built in Next.js with Claude — live at pathwise.anujaharsha.com.
- **WealthEngine — life-decision engine (2026):** A local-first planning tool for modeling long-horizon "what-if" life and financial scenarios on real numbers.
- **Warden — AI-agent authorization console (2026):** An access & guardrails console governing what autonomous AI agents are allowed to do — a permission engine for the agentic era.
- **Also:** Inkwell, a local-first writing studio with an AI coach; and WordU, a logic-driven word game for iOS and web.

PUBLICATIONS AND COMMUNITY

Community Leadership

- **Active Mentor on ADPList:** Mentoring designers on career growth, portfolio building, and enterprise UX.
- **Design and Leadership Writer:** Active contributor on Medium, sharing insights on design systems and leadership.

Industry Contributions

- **IBI Community Articles:** Authored two technical articles for the Cloud Software Group community on The Secret Behind Better BI and Enhancing UX in WebFOCUS DSML.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MIT xPRO

Professional Certificate: Designing and Building AI Products and Services

Georgia Institute of Technology

Professional Certificate in Human-Computer Interaction

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Open University

Master of Arts in English Literature

SNDT Women's University, Mumbai

Bachelor of Arts in English Literature

Mahatma Gandhi University

Bachelor of Arts in VFX & Animation